TRIPZY

Fast, Confident Travel Decisions

Product Requirements Document

PM Portfolio Case Study | B2C Mobile App | Travel Tech | 0→1 Product

B2C Mobile **Travel Tech** **0→1 Product**

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01 EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Product Vision

Tripzy is a **decision-first travel recommendation app** that helps users choose where to go in under 2 minutes. By combining a structured 5-question intake, behavioural algorithms, and group preference alignment, Tripzy eliminates the planning friction that prevents millions of people from converting travel intent into actual trips.

The Opportunity

India's domestic travel market is growing rapidly — yet planning remains fragmented, time-consuming, and socially complex. Existing platforms (MakeMyTrip, Tripadvisor, TripAdvisor) solve the *booking* and *inspiration* problems but leave the critical **destination decision** problem unsolved. Tripzy targets the decision layer that sits upstream of all booking intent.

< 2 min	3 picks	■30K–80K	> 40%
Time to first shortlist	Curated choices shown	Target user trip budget	7-day retention target

Key Product Decisions

- **Limit choices to exactly 3** — Reduces cognitive overload and increases decision confidence (Paradox of Choice)
- **Decision-first, not inspiration-first** — Unlike Pinterest or Instagram travel, Tripzy starts with constraints, not aspirations
- **Group sync before browsing** — Preference alignment happens upfront, not after individual research cycles
- **No booking on-platform** — Avoid marketplace complexity in MVP; focus on decision quality and redirect intent

Out of Scope (V1)

- Hotel/flight booking engine
- Itinerary builder or day-planner
- User-generated reviews or ratings
- Real-time pricing or availability integration
- International destinations (Phase 1: India only)

02 PROBLEM STATEMENT

"Travel planning is slow and overwhelming. Users spend excessive time researching, face decision fatigue from too many options, and struggle to align preferences when planning in groups."

Pain Point 1 — Time Overload

Urban professionals aged 20–35 spend 3–7 hours researching a 3-day domestic trip across multiple platforms including Tripadvisor, Reddit, YouTube, Instagram, and WhatsApp travel groups. There is no convergence point — each source offers different opinions with no personalised filtering.

- Research is scattered across 5+ platforms with no unified view
- Users open 20–40 browser tabs before making a tentative choice
- Decision is often deferred or abandoned, leading to missed trips

Pain Point 2 — Decision Fatigue

When users finally reach a shortlist, they face a classic paradox-of-choice problem. Tripadvisor shows hundreds of destinations; travel blogs are generic; no platform accounts for the user's specific budget, time window, group type, and travel style simultaneously.

- Too many options increase anxiety instead of confidence
- Users frequently second-guess their choices post-booking
- Decision velocity drops sharply when options exceed 5–7 choices

Pain Point 3 — Group Coordination Friction

35–50% of leisure trips in India involve groups of 2–6 people. Coordinating preferences across the group happens via WhatsApp threads that spiral into indecision — one person wants beaches, another wants mountains, and no one has a framework to converge.

- Average group decision takes 3–5 days with multiple back-and-forths
- Date alignment is a separate, unconnected problem
- Social dynamics cause individuals to defer rather than assert preference

Market Gap

No product in the Indian market explicitly solves the upstream decision problem for domestic leisure travel. Existing players occupy adjacent spaces:

Platform	What They Solve	What They Miss
MakeMyTrip / Goibibo	Booking & deal discovery	Destination decision
Tripadvisor / TripAdvisor	Reviews & inspiration	Personalised, time-bound choice
Google Travel	Itinerary & flights	Decision support for undecided users

Instagram / Pinterest	Mood-board inspiration	Practical decision with constraints
Tripzy	**Decision-first in <2 min**	**— (this is the gap we fill)**

03 USER PERSONA & RESEARCH

Target Segment

Urban, Tier-1 city residents aged 20–35 who travel 2–4 times a year for leisure, plan short trips (2–6 days), are budget-aware, and experience decision fatigue while choosing destinations due to information overload. Primarily mobile-first users who trust curated, personalised recommendations over exhaustive research.

Primary Persona — Arjun

Attribute	Detail
Name & Age	Arjun, 27
Occupation	Marketing Manager at a mid-size tech company, Bengaluru
Income	■10–18 LPA — budget-conscious but willing to spend on experiences
Travel Frequency	3–4 trips/year; mostly long weekends (2–4 days)
Primary Goal	Plan a trip without spending hours researching
Key Frustration	"I know I want to travel but I spend more time planning than travelling"
App Behaviour	Heavy Zomato, Swiggy, Urban Company user — trusts curated lists and in-app recommendations
Device	iPhone 14 (primary), Mac (work) — mobile-first for discovery
Group Travel	60% of trips with 2–5 friends; coordination via WhatsApp is a major friction point

Jobs to Be Done (JTBD)

- **Functional:** "Help me find a destination that fits my budget, time, and style without hours of research"
- **Social:** "Help me coordinate and agree on a destination with my travel group without conflict"
- **Emotional:** "Give me the confidence that I've made a good choice so I can stop second-guessing"

04 PRODUCT HYPOTHESES

H1 — Time Constraint

Hypothesis:

If we reduce the effort and time required to discover suitable travel destinations, then users with limited time will be able to make a travel decision faster without feeling overwhelmed.

Underlying Assumption:

Time spent researching is a major blocker to trip planning. Users abandon the process — not because they don't want to travel, but because the research overhead is too high.

Validation Approach:

Track average session duration from first app open to first destination shortlist. Target: < 2 minutes. If users consistently exceed 5 minutes, the intake flow needs rethinking.

H2 — Decision Fatigue

Hypothesis:

If users are presented with a small, curated set of relevant travel options (exactly 3) instead of many choices, then decision fatigue will reduce and confidence in selection will increase.

Underlying Assumption:

Too many options leads to paralysis, not better decisions (Paradox of Choice, Schwartz 2004). Users in the target segment are accustomed to curated feeds — they trust algorithmic curation over exhaustive lists.

Validation Approach:

Track the % of users who select from the initial 3 options vs. those who request additional options. Track post-session confidence score (1–5 self-reported). Target: > 65% select from initial 3; confidence score > 4.0.

H3 — Group Planning Friction

Hypothesis:

If users can easily share, compare, and align on travel options with their group via a shareable link, then group coordination friction will reduce and final decisions will be made faster.

Underlying Assumption:

Most delays in group travel planning come from misaligned preferences and scattered communication — not from a lack of destination ideas. Centralising preference input eliminates the WhatsApp spiral.

Validation Approach:

Track time from group link share to confirmed destination selection. Track % of group-initiated sessions that reach a final decision within the session. Target: > 50% reach consensus within 24hrs.

05 SOLUTION OVERVIEW

Design Philosophy

Tripzy is a **decision-first** product. Every design decision, feature prioritisation, and UX pattern is optimised for *confident destination selection* — not for information consumption, inspiration, or booking. This is a deliberate constraint that differentiates Tripzy from all existing travel platforms.

Core Flow

Step 1 — Quick Intake

User answers 5 structured questions: budget range, number of days, travel vibe (adventure/relax/culture/food), group composition (solo/couple/friends/family), and preferred travel distance from their city.

Step 2 — AI Destination Matching

Backend algorithm maps user inputs to a destination profile matrix. Each destination has a multi-dimensional scoring model covering budget fit, vibe alignment, seasonal suitability, and group type compatibility.

Step 3 — 3 Curated Results

Exactly 3 destinations are presented. Each card shows: destination name, 1-line fit reason, key highlight, honest trade-off, estimated trip cost, best time to visit, and a match score.

Step 4 — Save or Share

User can save shortlist, share it with their group via a link, or proceed to explore booking options on partner platforms.

Step 5 (Group) — Group Preference Merge

Each group member completes the same intake independently. Results are merged and 2–3 group-optimised destinations are shown with agreement indicators and conflict flags.

Competitive Differentiation

Tripzy does not compete with OTAs or travel blogs — it **complements** them by solving the upstream decision problem. Once a user picks a destination on Tripzy, they are redirected to booking platforms, keeping the value chain intact while capturing decision intent.

06 FEATURE SPECIFICATIONS

F-01 | Quick Trip Snapshot

Priority: **P0 — MVP Core** Validates: **H1 (Time Constraint)**

A 5-question intake flow that captures the user's travel constraints and preferences in under 90 seconds. The flow is designed to be mobile-first, tap-based (no typing), and progressive (each question builds on the prior).

Intake Questions:

#	Question	Options
Q1	Budget Range	4 options: Under ■10K / ■10K–25K / ■25K–50K / ■50K+
Q2	Trip Duration	4 options: Weekend (2D) / Short (3-4D) / Week (5-7D) / Longer
Q3	Travel Vibe	4 options: Adventure / Relax & Unwind / Culture & History / Food & Nightlife
Q4	Group Type	4 options: Solo / Couple / Friends (3-6) / Family (with kids)
Q5	Distance	3 options: Nearby (<4h travel) / Mid-range (4-8h) / Anywhere in India

Acceptance Criteria:

- User completes intake in ≤ 5 taps (no keyboard input required for core flow)
- System delivers first set of 3 recommendations within 3 seconds of intake completion
- Each recommendation card shows: name, fit reason, trade-off, cost estimate, match %
- User can re-run intake with different parameters without re-onboarding

Edge Cases:

- User selects contradictory inputs (e.g., budget under ■10K + 7-day trip): show best-fit disclaimer
- No matching destinations found: show nearest matches with clear explanation of trade-offs
- User wants more than 3 options: allow 'Show me 3 more' as a secondary action (tracked as engagement signal)

F-02 | Group Preference Alignment

Priority: **P1 — Phase 2** Validates: **H3 (Group Coordination)**

Enables one user to initiate a group planning session by sharing a unique link. Each member completes the Quick Trip Snapshot independently. The system merges all preference vectors and returns 2–3 destinations that optimise for group fit.

Acceptance Criteria:

- Group link is generated after solo user completes their intake
- Each group member who opens the link completes their own intake (stored anonymously per session)
- System shows merged results once ≥ 2 members have completed intake
- Agreement indicators show which destinations received thumbs-up from all members

- Conflict flags highlight top mismatched preferences (e.g., 'Alice prefers adventure; Bob prefers relaxation')
- Date availability matrix allows each member to mark available dates; overlap is highlighted

Edge Cases:

- Only 1 member completes intake: show solo results with prompt to invite others
- Group members choose conflicting vibes: show compromise destination with clear trade-off explanation
- Large group (>6): cap at 6 preference sets; show notice for groups beyond this

F-03 | Destination Result Cards

Priority: **P0 — MVP Core**	Validates: **H2 (Decision Fatigue)**

Each of the 3 recommendation cards is designed to deliver maximum decision confidence with minimum reading time. Cards are structured to surface what matters most — not everything.

Acceptance Criteria:

- Card displays: destination name, state/region, hero image (from curated library)
- 1-line 'Why it fits you' based on intake inputs (dynamically generated)
- 1 honest trade-off (e.g., 'Crowded in season; best to visit off-peak')
- Estimated trip cost range (per person, based on budget tier)
- Match score (out of 100) shown as a colour-coded ring
- Primary CTA: 'Shortlist' | Secondary: 'Explore Hotels' (redirect to partner)

Edge Cases:

- Image load failure: show branded placeholder with destination name
- Match score < 50: do not show this destination; replace with next-best match

07 SUCCESS METRICS & KPIs

Metrics are organised by the product funnel: Acquisition → Activation → Engagement → Retention → Revenue. Primary metrics are directly tied to the product hypotheses. Secondary metrics provide leading indicators and contextual signal.

Metric	Definition	Target	H#	Priority
Time to First Shortlist	Session start to 3 recommendations displayed	< 2 min	**H1**	Primary
Onboarding Completion	% users completing intake on first session	> 75%	**H1**	Primary
Shortlists / Month	Avg. planning sessions per monthly active user	> 2.5	**H2**	Primary
Group Link Share Rate	% sessions where group link is shared	> 30%	**H3**	Primary
Confidence Score	Post-session self-reported score (1-5)	> 4.0/5	**H2**	Primary
7-Day Retention	% users returning within 7 days	> 40%	**H1+H2**	Primary
Select from Initial 3	% shortlisting without requesting more options	> 65%	**H2**	Secondary
Group Consensus Rate	% group sessions reaching agreed destination	> 50% 24h	**H3**	Primary
Booking Redirect CTR	% shortlists clicking through to partner booking	> 20%	**Biz**	Secondary
MAU Growth (M3-M6)	Month-over-month growth in monthly active users	> 15% MoM	**Biz**	Secondary

Anti-Metrics (What We Don't Optimise For)

- Time spent in app (more ≠ better — speed to decision is the value proposition)
- Number of destinations viewed (we want fewer views, higher confidence)
- Pages per session (depth of browsing is not a signal of quality for this product)

08 PRODUCT ROADMAP

The roadmap is structured as a 3-phase launch, each phase anchored to hypothesis validation before advancing. Phase 1 validates the core decision-making loop; Phase 2 adds group coordination; Phase 3 activates monetisation and growth loops.

Phase 1 — MVP

Timeline: Month 1–2 | **Goal:** Validate H1: Time to Decision

Feature / Deliverable	Priority
Quick Trip Snapshot (F-01)	P0
Destination Result Cards (F-03)	P0
Solo user flow end-to-end	P0
Basic destination database (50 Indian destinations)	P0
Shortlist save & share (static link)	P1
Analytics event tracking (Amplitude/Mixpanel)	P0

Phase 2 — Group + Confidence

Timeline: Month 3–4 | **Goal:** Validate H2 + H3

Feature / Deliverable	Priority
Group Preference Alignment (F-02)	P0
Agreement & conflict indicators	P0
Date availability matrix	P1
Destination database expansion (150+ destinations)	P1
Confidence score collection (post-session NPS variant)	P0
Push notification — re-engagement reminders	P2

Phase 3 — Monetisation + Growth

Timeline: Month 5–6 | **Goal:** Revenue + Retention Loops

Feature / Deliverable	Priority
Booking redirect with affiliate tracking	P0
Promoted destination listings (partner hotels)	P1
Travel demand data product (B2B)	P2
Referral programme (group invite incentive)	P1

Personalisation layer (preference memory across sessions)	P1
iOS & Android native apps (if PWA validated)	P2

09 BUSINESS MODEL & MONETISATION

Tripzy operates on a **free-to-use, platform monetisation** model. The core planning product is free — monetisation is downstream of user value, not in conflict with it. This approach prioritises user trust and product-market fit before revenue extraction.

Stream 1 — Affiliate Commission

Revenue Tier: **PRIMARY**

After a user selects a destination, they are offered links to book hotels, flights, and activities through Tripzy's partner network. Tripzy earns 4–8% commission per confirmed booking. This is the primary revenue stream and requires no additional product complexity — only API partnerships with MakeMyTrip, Booking.com, and Airbnb.

- **Target conversion rate:** > 20% of shortlisted users click through
- **Average commission per booking:** ■400–800 (based on ■8K–15K avg. hotel booking)
- **Break-even (MoM):** ~1,500 redirected bookings / month

Stream 2 — Promoted Listings

Revenue Tier: **SECONDARY**

Hotels, resorts, and experience providers can pay to be featured in the curated recommendation set when their property matches the user's stated travel profile. Promoted placements are clearly labelled ('Sponsored') and must meet the minimum match score threshold — preventing degradation of recommendation quality.

- **Pricing model:** CPM (per 1,000 impressions) + CPC (per card click)
- **Floor price:** ■500 CPM / ■25 CPC
- **Monthly revenue potential (Phase 3):** ■3L–8L at 50 active partners

Stream 3 — Travel Demand Intelligence

Revenue Tier: **FUTURE**

Anonymised, aggregated travel intent data (destination popularity by budget tier, group type, and season) has significant commercial value for hospitality brands, tourism boards, and hotel chains planning inventory and marketing. This becomes viable at scale (100K+ MAU).

- **Data product format:** Quarterly reports + real-time API feed
- **Target buyers:** State tourism boards, hotel chains, OTA analytics teams
- **Est. revenue at scale:** ■5L–25L per enterprise contract

10 APPENDIX

Open Questions (At Time of Writing)

#	Question	Context / Trade-off
OQ-01	**Destination Data Source**	Should destination data be manually curated by the team or sourced via a third-party API (e.g., TripAdvisor Content API)? Curated ensures quality; API enables scale.
OQ-02	**Match Score Algorithm**	What weighting should the match scoring model apply across budget fit, vibe alignment, and group type? Requires A/B testing post-launch.
OQ-03	**Monetisation Timing**	At what MAU threshold should we introduce promoted listings? Premature monetisation before PMF can degrade trust.
OQ-04	**Group Link Privacy**	Should group members see each other's individual preference inputs, or only the merged result? Privacy-first vs. transparency trade-off.
OQ-05	**Reactivation Strategy**	What is the optimal re-engagement trigger — upcoming long weekends, seasonal destination drops, or group link expiry reminders?

Key Assumptions

- Target users (20–35, Tier-1, 2–4 trips/year) are the primary adopters in Phase 1
- Mobile-first PWA is sufficient for MVP; native app investment deferred to Phase 3
- Destination database of 50 curated Indian destinations is sufficient for MVP validation
- Users are willing to input 5 questions before seeing results (no progressive reveal needed at V1)
- Affiliate partner APIs (MakeMyTrip, Booking.com) are accessible and offer standard commission structures
- The primary monetisation event is a redirected booking, not in-app purchase or subscription

Revision History

Version	Date	Author	Change Summary
v1.0	2024-Q4	PM Author	Initial PRD — Problem, Persona, Hypotheses, MVP Feature Spec
v1.1	—	—	Pending: Group feature detailed spec, partner API requirements
v2.0	—	—	Planned: Post-MVP retro, H1/H2/H3 validation results